SUMITH PA

Lead Automation Architect | QA Lead

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Audio Profile Link **LinkedIn**

GitHub Works : AI_Test_Automation_Framework_Walkthrough

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Lead Automation Architect and QA Lead with 13+ years of expertise driving quality engineering excellence, test automation strategy, and CI/CD pipeline design across Banking, Telecom, Healthcare, and Insurance domains. Proven Test Manager and people leader with a track record of building, managing, and mentoring high-performing QA teams of 10+ engineers, owning end-to-end quality strategy, and elevating organisational test maturity from ground up. Expert in Agile/Scrum delivery, shift-left testing, BDD/TDD, and AI-driven test automation using LLMs and Copilot to accelerate release cycles. Architect of enterprise-grade frameworks adopted by 150+ teams — cutting regression cycles by 70%, reducing manual test design effort by 40%, and improving team delivery efficiency by 30%. Adept at stakeholder management, QA governance, OKR/KPI reporting, release management, presenting automation ROI to C-level leadership, and establishing quality best practices at scale across global programmes.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built automation framework adopted by 150+ Telstra teams — reduced regression execution time by 30%, manual test design effort by 40%, and improved team delivery efficiency by 30%.
- Led and managed QA teams of 10+ automation architects across Telstra and CBA — drove coding standards, mentorship programmes, and QA governance resulting in organisation-wide adoption of best practices.
- Pioneered AI-driven test automation using LLMs + Jira integration — auto-generates BDD/TDD test cases from user stories, achieving shift-left testing at scale and cutting manual test design effort by 40%.
- Designed and delivered QA sign-off governance and release management processes at CBA and Telstra — defined entry/exit criteria, managed escalations, and owned the end-to-end test execution process across functional, regression, integration, and UAT phases for major regulatory programmes.
- Architected serverless CI/CD pipelines (AWS Lambda + S3 + CloudWatch) at Telstra — eliminated dedicated build servers, reduced infrastructure costs, and enabled continuous testing across 150+ delivery teams.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Test Automation Architecture | BDD / TDD | Agile / Scrum | Shift-Left Testing | CI/CD Pipelines

Selenium | Playwright | Appium | REST Assured | Karate | Cucumber BDD | JUnit | TestNG | Pytest

Java | Python | TypeScript | JavaScript | Spring Boot | AWS | Azure DevOps | Docker | Kubernetes

AI-Driven Test Automation | LLM Integration | Agentic Automation | Copilot Test Case Generation

UI Automation | API Automation | Mobile Automation | Cross-Browser Testing | Performance Testing

Risk-Based Testing | Continuous Testing | Regression Testing | Security Testing | Defect Management

Stakeholder Management | QA Metrics & ROI | Test Strategy | SDLC / STLC | Code Review | Team Leadership | OKR / KPI Reporting

Splunk Dashboards | Jira Zephyr Cloud | SWIFT | ISO 20022 | SAP UI | Pega (CCE) | Salesforce

QA Team Leadership | Test Management | Release Management | Hiring & Onboarding | Performance Management | QA Governance | Process Improvement

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages & Test Frameworks: Java, Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, Selenium, Playwright, Cucumber Behaviour-Driven Development (BDD), REST Assured, Karate, JUnit, TestNG, Pytest, Spring Boot

Test Automation & Quality Assurance (QA): Test Automation, Regression Testing, Risk-Based Testing, API Automation, UI Automation, Mobile Automation, Cross-Browser Testing, End-to-End Testing, Performance Testing, Security Testing, Shift-Left Testing, Test-Driven Development (TDD), Continuous Testing, Defect Management, Test Strategy

QA Leadership & Management: Test Management, Release Management, Team Building, Hiring & Onboarding, Performance Reviews, Capacity Planning, Sprint Planning, Resource Allocation, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Vendor Management, QA Governance, OKR & KPI Reporting, Process Improvement, Release Sign-Off, Escalation Management, Test Lead, People Management

AI & Innovation: Agentic Automation, Large Language Model (LLM) Integration, Copilot Test Case Generation, Scriptless Automation Proof of Concept (POC), ARD Modelling-Based Testing, Auto-Healing Frameworks

Mobile & Cloud / CI/CD: Appium, Giga Fox Cloud, AWS Lambda, AWS S3, CloudWatch, Azure DevOps, Continuous Integration / Continuous Delivery (CI/CD), TeamCity, Bamboo, GitLab, Docker, Kubernetes, Linux

Reporting & Metrics: Splunk Dashboards, Jira Zephyr Cloud, Process Metrics, Product Metrics, Project Metrics, Defect Density, Automation Return on Investment (ROI), Test Coverage Key Performance Indicators (KPIs), RACI Matrix

Domains & Platforms: Banking, Payments, Telecom, Healthcare, Insurance, SAP UI, Pega (CCE), Salesforce, SWIFT, ISO 20022

CERTIFICATIONS

- ISTQB Advanced Level Test Automation Engineer (CTAL-TAE) [In Progress]
- AWS Certified Developer – Associate [Planned 2026]
- Microsoft Azure DevOps Engineer Expert [Planned 2026]

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Automation Architect | QA Lead — November 2025 – Present

Ascendion Inc • Bangalore, India

- Designing the reference automation framework blueprint for enterprise clients in Agile/Scrum environments — covering UI (User Interface), API, and integration testing standards reusable across multiple engagements.
- Built an agentic AI automation pipeline integrating Large Language Models (LLMs) with Jira — reads user stories, pulls context from Confluence and architecture documents, and auto-generates Cucumber Behaviour-Driven Development (BDD) / Test-Driven Development (TDD) test cases, applying shift-left testing principles.
- Leading technical interviews, training junior engineers, and collaborating with pre-sales teams to define test automation strategy during client onboarding and Request for Proposal (RFP) phases.
- Acting as QA Lead for client engagements — accountable for test planning, resource allocation, risk assessment, and quality sign-off; liaising with delivery managers and product owners to align QA activities with programme milestones.
- Defined and owned the end-to-end QA strategy for client delivery programmes — established test scope, test types (functional, regression, integration, UAT), and quality metrics aligned to project timelines and risk appetite.
- Facilitated sprint ceremonies as QA Lead — participated in sprint planning, backlog grooming, and retrospectives to embed quality practices early in delivery cycles and drive shift-left adoption across client teams.
- Tracked and reported defect lifecycle metrics (open/closed/deferred rates, severity distribution, retest cycles) to programme leadership — provided weekly QA status reports and raised blockers proactively to prevent release slippage.

Lead Automation Architect | QA Lead — August 2024 – November 2025

Telstra • Bangalore, India

- Built a Playwright-Cucumber Behaviour-Driven Development (BDD) framework now used by 150+ Telstra teams — cut regression testing execution time by 70% and improved team efficiency by 30%.
- Enabled developer-led testing in Agile/Scrum delivery by providing the same framework in TypeScript, allowing development teams to contribute directly and accelerate release cycles via continuous testing.
- Defined a 3-tier Quality Assurance (QA) metrics framework (Process, Product, and Project levels) — integrated defect density, severity ratios, and coverage Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) into Splunk dashboards and Jira Zephyr Cloud for real-time leadership visibility.

- Applied Return on Investment (ROI) metrics (test coverage, cost of testing, schedule variance) to stakeholder management discussions — secured continued leadership investment in test automation infrastructure.
- Designed serverless Continuous Integration and Continuous Delivery (CI/CD) pipelines using AWS Lambda + S3 + CloudWatch, eliminating dedicated build servers and reducing infrastructure costs.
- Pioneered Copilot AI and ARD modelling-based test case generation — reduced manual test design effort by 40% and expanded regression coverage across delivery programs.
- Led a 10+ engineer automation architect group — enforced coding standards, design patterns (Page Object Model, Singleton, Factory), and mentorship practices adopted organisation-wide.
- Owned QA team resourcing, onboarding, and performance management — conducted regular 1-on-1s, quarterly reviews, and career development planning for direct reports, growing team capability and retention.
- Served as QA sign-off authority for production releases — defined entry/exit criteria, managed escalations, and ensured quality gates were met across all delivery streams in alignment with program governance.
- Collaborated with Product Owners and Business Analysts during requirement reviews — identified ambiguities early, raised testability concerns, and ensured acceptance criteria were clear and measurable before sprint kickoff.
- Owned the test estimation and capacity planning process — broke down testing effort by feature, assigned tasks across the team, and tracked progress against sprint commitments using Jira dashboards.
- Managed cross-team dependencies as QA Lead — coordinated testing across multiple squads, resolved blockers, and maintained alignment between QA, development, and DevOps to support continuous delivery at scale.

Lead Automation Architect | QA Lead — June 2021 – August 2024

Commonwealth Bank of Australia (CBA) • Bangalore, India

- Built CBA's test automation framework and Quality Assurance (QA) practice from the ground up — grew into enterprise-wide adoption across API, UI, database, and mobile platforms following Agile/Scrum and Software Development Life Cycle (SDLC) standards.
- Led test automation for a major regulatory payment migration program — validated complex payment message transformations across UI, backend databases, and APIs for both modern and legacy banking systems (SWIFT, ISO 20022).
- Developed cross-platform mobile test automation (Android + iOS) using Appium + GigaFox Cloud, and a hybrid framework combining web, API, and mobile testing for end-to-end Know Your Customer (KYC) workflows.
- Built custom Splunk dashboards and Jira Zephyr Cloud integrations for real-time quality visibility; enhanced framework with auto-retries and parallel execution to improve regression testing efficiency.
- Conducted risk-based testing prioritisation to align regression coverage with highest-impact business areas.
- Mentored manual testers into automation engineers via a structured training program; performed regular code reviews to maintain enterprise quality standards.
- Led QA chapter activities for the CBA payments programme — facilitated weekly QA syncs, maintained a shared defect triage process, and drove consistency in testing standards across multiple delivery squads.
- Partnered with the Release Manager to govern go-live readiness — produced test summary reports, tracked open defect SLAs, and provided formal QA sign-off before each production deployment for the SWIFT/ISO 20022 migration.
- Acted as the primary QA point of contact for business stakeholders — translated complex regulatory and functional requirements into comprehensive test plans, and presented QA progress and risk status in steering committee meetings.

Senior Automation Engineer | QA Architect — April 2019 – June 2021

Standard Chartered Bank • Bangalore, India

- Architected end-to-end test automation for critical banking workflows (Customer Onboarding, Know Your Customer (KYC), Card/Account Creation) — built REST Assured API and JUnit UI frameworks covering the full Software Testing Life Cycle (STLC) from UI to backend database.
- Ran a successful scriptless automation Proof of Concept (POC) using Karate, enabling non-Java engineers to contribute to test automation and widening the team's automation footprint.
- Drove Automation Test Strategy, risk-based testing feasibility studies, and rigorous code reviews — ensured regulatory compliance and framework maintainability across all deliverables.
- Collaborated cross-functionally with development and business stakeholders to translate banking requirements into maintainable automated test suites in an Agile/Scrum environment.
- Reviewed and analysed business requirements and functional specifications — identified gaps and testability issues during requirement reviews, and contributed to refining acceptance criteria with Product Owners and BAs, reducing requirement-related defects by 25%.
- Designed and maintained detailed test plans and test case repositories covering 500+ test cases for KYC, Customer Onboarding, and Card/Account workflows — ensured traceability from requirements to test coverage and maintained documentation in Jira and Confluence.
- Performed exploratory, functional, and regression testing for critical banking modules — logged, triaged, and tracked defects through to resolution, and produced test summary reports for stakeholder sign-off ahead of each release.

Senior QA Automation Engineer — May 2018 – March 2019

Wells Fargo • Bangalore, India

- Architected a Cucumber-TestNG + Page Object Model (POM) framework for core banking and treasury systems, automating complex Pega applications and REST APIs — improved test accuracy and delivery efficiency across critical business workflows.
- Designed and executed end-to-end API test automation for back-end banking services, validating data integrity and system reliability across core transaction processing pipelines.
- Standardised test scenarios using Gherkin language for clear, business-readable documentation — enabling Product Owners and Business Analysts to review and validate test coverage without technical knowledge, supporting shift-left testing adoption.
- Enforced Git-based version control and peer code review practices, improving script maintainability and enabling seamless collaboration across distributed Quality Assurance (QA) engineers.
- Conducted thorough functional and regression testing for core banking and treasury workflows — developed 300+ test cases from business requirements and technical specifications, ensuring comprehensive coverage across positive, negative, and boundary scenarios, achieving 95%+ test coverage.
- Managed the defect lifecycle end-to-end in Jira — reported, triaged, and tracked defects in collaboration with developers, validated fixes, and ensured release-blocking issues were resolved within agreed SLAs.
- Participated in requirement walkthrough sessions and contributed to test estimation — provided QA input during sprint planning to scope testing effort and flag dependencies, supporting on-time delivery within Agile/Scrum cycles.

QA Automation Architect — July 2016 – April 2018

HCL Technologies (BNP Paribas) • Chennai, India

- Served as sole Automation Framework Architect for BNP Paribas — designed and delivered Cucumber-TestNG + Page Object Model (POM) and Karate-Cucumber frameworks for Treasury Terminal and Core Banking systems, covering front-end UI and back-end REST/SOAP API testing.
- Automated complex Pega applications, significantly improving test coverage for critical business process workflows; managed a team of automation engineers through code reviews, task allocation, and on-time delivery.
- Collaborated with development leads and business stakeholders to define automation scope, risk areas, and test strategy aligned to Software Development Life Cycle (SDLC) and release cycles.
- Executed functional, system integration, and regression testing for Treasury Terminal and Core Banking applications — developed 400+ comprehensive test cases from functional specifications covering UI workflows, data validations, and REST/SOAP API responses, achieving 90%+ regression coverage.
- Led defect triage meetings with development and business teams — categorised defects by severity and priority, tracked resolution timelines, and maintained defect status reports to keep stakeholders informed ahead of release milestones.
- Supported UAT coordination for BNP Paribas business users — prepared test data, facilitated UAT sessions, captured business feedback, and ensured sign-off was obtained from business stakeholders before production deployments.

Senior QA Engineer | Automation — August 2013 – June 2016

Cognizant Technology Solutions • Chennai, India

- Progressed from Programmer Analyst to Senior Software Engineer — transitioned from Java development to test automation, delivering solutions for Nationwide Insurance and CareFirst BlueCross BlueShield using Selenium WebDriver, UFT, Cucumber, and Java across web, mobile, and desktop platforms.
- Core contributor to CRAFT (Cognizant's Reusable Automation Framework for Testers) — standardised framework adopted across multiple project teams to improve consistency and productivity.
- Executed full Software Testing Life Cycle (STLC) activities including test planning, execution, and defect management; conducted specialised security testing for a Struts remediation project.
- Analysed business requirements and functional specifications for insurance and healthcare applications (Nationwide Insurance and CareFirst BlueCross BlueShield) — mapped requirements to test scenarios and identified gaps and edge cases prior to test design.
- Wrote 600+ detailed manual test cases covering functional, regression, and boundary scenarios — documented expected results, test data requirements, and pre-conditions; maintained test case traceability matrices to ensure full requirement coverage across 3 major insurance and healthcare platforms.
- Executed test cases manually across web, mobile, and desktop platforms — logged 200+ defects with detailed reproduction steps and severity classification in HP ALM / Quality Centre; performed retesting and regression cycles post-fix validation, achieving 98% defect closure rate within sprint cycles.
- Participated in daily standups and sprint reviews — communicated testing progress, raised blockers, and contributed to test status reporting; supported the QA team in preparing release notes and test closure reports for project handover.

EDUCATION

Master of Computer Applications (MCA) | Bharathiar University, Coimbatore(Distance Education) — **2021**

Bachelor of Computer Applications (BCA) | Bharathiar University, Coimbatore — **2011**